

Powerful hunter

The huge and powerful snowy owl glides silently over the frozen tundra searching for lemmings and voles to eat. It can catch up to 10 lemmings in one day and is strong enough to catch and kill hares. Its white and black speckled plumage camouflages it against the snow, and the thick feathers on its legs keep it warm.

Snowy owl
(*Bubo scandiacus*)
Length: up to
2 ft 1 in (64 cm)
Wingspan: up to
5 ft 5 in (1.65 m)



Siberian lemming
(*Lemmus sibiricus*)
Length: up to
6 in (16 cm)



Snowshoe hooves

The reindeer, or caribou, has broad hooves that help it walk in deep snow. It also uses its hooves to scrape away snow to eat lichen and moss. Some reindeer migrate between summer breeding grounds on the tundra and winter feeding grounds in the forests. Unlike other deer, the male and the female both have antlers.



Reindeer
(*Rangifer tarandus*)
Body length: up to
7 ft 2 in (2.2 m)
Tail: up to
8 in (21 cm)

On the move

Every three or four years, the number of lemmings grows so much that thousands leave their nests to find new homes. Once they are on the move, lemmings do not stop, even in big towns or at busy roads. Many are eaten or die from exhaustion or starvation. Others drown trying to cross rivers, lakes, or the sea.

Underground larders

The Arctic ground squirrel stores food in its underground burrow during the short summer period. It makes several "larders" of food to last it through its winter sleep, or hibernation, and eats a lot in the summer to build up stores of body fat. If the ground squirrel senses danger, it makes a loud call to warn others.



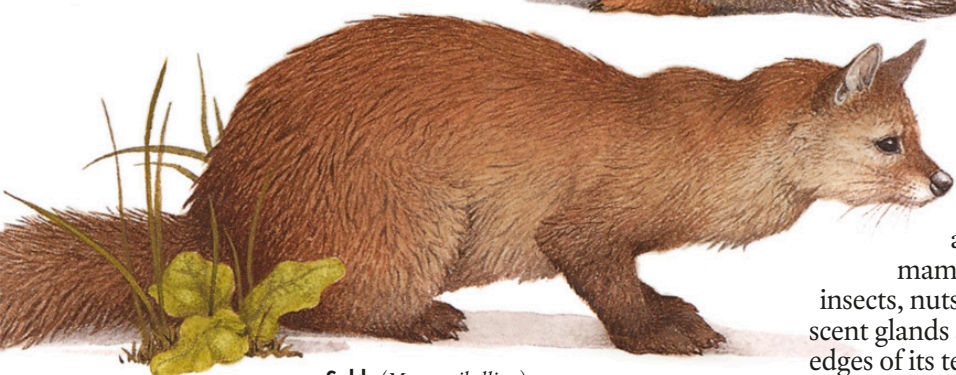
Arctic ground squirrel
(*Spermophilus parryi*)
Body: up to 10.5 in (27 cm)
Tail: up to 4 in (11 cm)



Hazel grouse (*Bonasa bonasia*)
Length: up to 15.8 in (40 cm)

Speckled feathers

The brown, speckled markings on the feathers of the female hazel grouse help hide her from enemies while she is sitting on her eggs. The hazel grouse has large flight muscles, which also act as a store of food. Grouse are the most common and widespread birds in the conifer forests.



Sable (*Martes zibellina*)
Body length: up to 22 in (56 cm)
Tail: up to 7.5 in (19 cm)

Fur coat

The sable has a beautiful, thick coat and was hunted almost to extinction for its fur. Some have been reared in captivity and released back into the wild, so the sable is no longer an endangered species. It feeds on small mammals, such as voles, as well as fish, insects, nuts, and berries. It has well-developed scent glands and uses this scent to mark the edges of its territory.

Siberian tit
(*Parus cinctus*)
Length: up to
5.5 in (14 cm)



Cone eater

The Siberian jay uses its strong beak to break open tree cones and reach the seeds inside. The number of Siberian jays are closely linked to the number of cones on the trees—when there are few cones, their numbers fall dramatically. When food is in short supply, they move into towns and villages in search of scraps.



Siberian jay
(*Perisoreus infaustus*)
Length: up to 12 in (31 cm)

Energy saver

The Siberian tit stays in the forests year round, despite the freezing winter temperatures. At night, its heartbeat and other body processes slow down, and its temperature drops so that it uses up less energy. This helps it survive when energy-giving food is hard to find.